

COLLECTION · LIFE SITUATIONS

Buying and Selling at the Same Time

Move without getting stuck — coordinate both transactions

READ BEFORE YOU BEGIN

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Edition

Buying and Selling at the Same Time

Move without getting stuck — coordinate both transactions

Selling your current property and buying a new one at the same time is a balancing act: financial, logistical and timing questions all intertwine. Well planned, it's done calmly.

This guide covers the scenarios (sell first, buy first), the tools to bridge the gap, and coordinating the dates.

Each chapter ends with a lined “My notes” page.

Selling your property and buying another at the same time is a balancing act: finances, logistics and timing intertwine. This guide covers choosing the sequence, the tools to bridge the gap, coordinating the dates and how to avoid carrying two properties.

Well planned, the exercise becomes a simple series of controlled steps.

CHAPTER

Sell first or buy first?

Choosing the sequence suited to your risk.

Everything comes down to the order of operations, and each has its downside:

- **Sell first:** you know your exact budget and sell without pressure, but risk having to find temporary housing.
- **Buy first:** you secure your next home, but risk paying for two properties if the old one is slow to sell.

The **sale condition** (making an offer conditional on the sale of your property) is a tool to reduce this risk.

Everything comes down to the order: sell first (exact budget known, no pressure, but the risk of finding temporary housing) or buy first (next home secured, but the risk of paying for two properties). The sale condition (offering conditional on the sale of your property) reduces this risk.

EMILIE'S TIP

If your budget can't absorb two mortgages, lean toward “sell first” or use a sale condition. Peace of mind is often worth more than the perfect house found too early.

CHAPTER

Bridging the financial gap

Managing the lag between the two transactions.

If the dates don't coincide, or if you buy before receiving your sale proceeds, tools exist:

- **Bridge loan:** temporary financing until the sale proceeds come in.
- **Line of credit:** to cover a short gap.
- Negotiating compatible **possession dates**.

The bridge loan is the most common tool: it covers precisely the gap between the purchase and the sale.

If the dates don't coincide, tools bridge the gap: the bridge loan (temporary financing until the sale proceeds come in), a line of credit, or negotiated possession dates. Talk about the bridge loan with your mortgage broker **BEFORE** making an offer.

EMILIE'S TIP

*Talk about the bridge loan with your mortgage broker **BEFORE** making an offer.*

Knowing that the financial bridge is possible (and at what cost) completely changes your room to maneuver.

CHAPTER

Coordinating dates and logistics

Orchestrating the two closings and the move.

Ideally, align the **possession dates** (sale and purchase) as much as possible for a smooth move.

Failing that, plan for:

- Temporary **storage**.
- Transitional **housing**.
- A **margin** in the schedule.

A broker who handles both transactions can synchronize the deadlines and anticipate the friction points.

Ideally, align the possession dates for a smooth move; failing that, plan for storage, transitional housing and a margin in the schedule. A broker who handles both transactions can synchronize the deadlines and anticipate the friction.

EMILIE'S TIP

Ideally entrust the purchase AND the sale to the same broker. They see both calendars at once and can line up the dates to save you a double move.

CHAPTER

Avoiding costly double holding

Limiting the risk of paying for two properties.

The worst scenario is ending up with **two properties on your hands**. A few safeguards:

- Price **your current property well so it sells fast**. Use a
- sale condition **on the purchase when possible**. Negotiate
- flexible dates **on the seller's side**. Keep a
- financial cushion **to absorb a few weeks of overlap**. Anticipating the worst scenario is exactly what keeps you from living it.

The worst scenario is two properties on your hands. Safeguards: price your current property well so it sells fast, use a sale condition, negotiate flexible dates and keep a cushion. Don't overprice “just in case”: that's what makes sales drag on.

Emilie's tip

A WELL-PRICED, WELL-PRESENTED PROPERTY SELLS FASTER — AND THAT'S YOUR BEST PROTECTION AGAINST DOUBLE HOLDING. DON'T OVERPRICE “JUST IN CASE”: THAT'S WHAT MAKES SALES DRAG ON.

The game plan, step by step

CHAPTER

Stringing the two transactions together calmly.

A successful sequence follows a clear outline:

Determine the sequence

1. **(sell or buy first) according to your risk.** Validate the financing
2. **and explore the bridge loan.** Go to market
3. **or shop in parallel, depending on the sequence.** Coordinate the
4. **possession dates.**
5. **Synchronize** the two closings at the notary.

Well planned, the balancing act becomes a simple series of controlled steps.

A successful sequence follows an outline: determine the sequence according to my risk, validate the financing and the bridge loan, go to market or shop in parallel, coordinate the dates, then synchronize the two closings. Write your plan on one page with the key dates.

EMILIE'S TIP

Write your game plan on a single page with the key dates. With the overview in hand, the decisions become obvious and the stress comes down.

IN PRACTICE

Action plan

Your next steps, concretely.

This week

1. Determine my sequence (sell or buy first).
2. Assess my ability to absorb a gap.

Within 30 days

1. Explore the bridge loan with my mortgage broker.
2. Coordinate the possession dates.

Next

1. Entrust both transactions to the same broker to synchronize everything.

My game plan

1. Determine my sequence and explore the bridge loan before making an offer.
2. Coordinate the possession dates and keep a safety cushion.

REFERENCES

Resources & glossary

- Sale condition: making an offer conditional on the sale of your property.
 - Bridge loan: temporary financing covering the gap between purchase and sale.
 - Possession date: the date of taking possession, to be coordinated.
 - Double holding: a period when you hold two properties, to be minimized.
 - Sequence: sell first or buy first, according to risk.
-
- Sale condition: making an offer conditional on the sale of your property.
 - Bridge loan: temporary financing covering the purchase/sale gap.
 - Possession date: the date of taking possession, to be coordinated.
 - Double holding: a period when you hold two properties, to be minimized.
 - Sequence: sell first or buy first, according to risk.

GOING FURTHER

Quiz — test your knowledge

1. Selling first mainly lets you:

- A) Pay for two houses
- B) Know your exact budget and sell without pressure
- C) Avoid the notary
- D) Double the taxes

2. Buying first risks:

- A) Reducing the choice
- B) Making you pay for two properties if the old one lingers
- C) Cancelling the sale
- D) Lowering the taxes

3. The sale condition lets you:

- A) Buy with no conditions
- B) Make an offer conditional on the sale of your property
- C) Pay less
- D) Avoid the notary

4. The bridge loan serves to:

- A) Renovate
- B) Cover the gap between the purchase and receiving the sale proceeds
- C) Pay the taxes
- D) Insure the house

5. You should talk about the bridge loan:

- A) After closing
- B) Before making an offer
- C) Never
- D) With the city

6. Ideally, on the dates side, you should:

- A) Ignore them
- B) Align the possession dates
- C) Move twice
- D) Set them at random

7. Entrusting both transactions to the same broker lets you:

- A) Pay more
- B) Synchronize the deadlines
- C) Complicate everything
- D) Avoid the sale

8. Double holding is:

- A) A tax advantage
- B) Holding two properties at once, to be minimized
- C) An insurance
- D) A condition

9. The best protection against double holding is:

- A) Overpricing your property
- B) Pricing it well so it sells fast
- C) Not selling it
- D) Waiting for winter

10. A good game plan ideally fits:

- A) In ten binders
- B) On one page with the key dates
- C) In your head only
- D) At the notary's

Answer key

- 1. **B** — Budget known (ch. 1).
- 2. **B** — Risk of double holding (ch. 1).
- 3. **B** — A risk-reduction tool (ch. 1).
- 4. **B** — Temporary financing (ch. 2).
- 5. **B** — Anticipate the financing (ch. 2).
- 6. **B** — Align the possessions (ch. 3).
- 7. **B** — Coordination (ch. 3).
- 8. **B** — To be limited (ch. 4).

9. **B** — A good price = a fast sale (ch. 4).

10. **B** — An overview (ch. 5).

Signé PAR Em

*Thank you for reading. May this guide help you
decide with confidence, with all the information
in hand.*

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